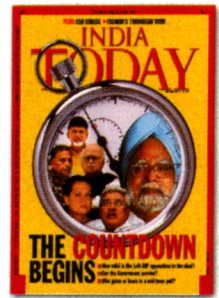
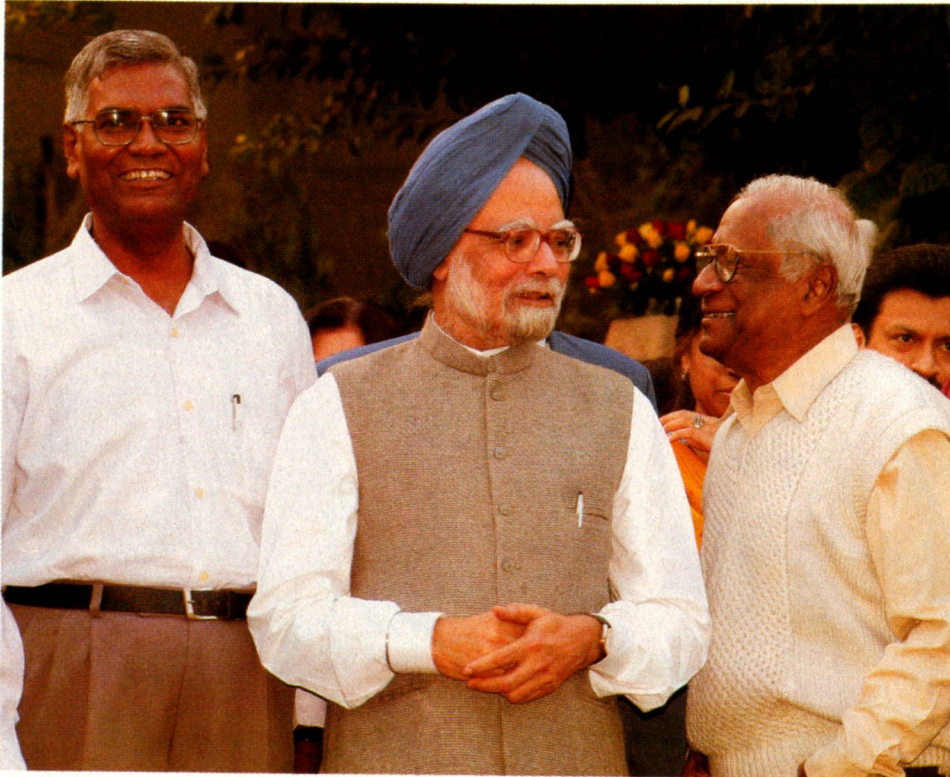


SIPRA DAS



"The Countdown Begins",
September 3, 2007

"The main business of political parties is to make or break the Government. Who is bothered about good governance and development?"

ANIKET SINGH, *Mohali*

Deal or No Deal

The nuclear mess is the Congress's handiwork ("The Final Countdown", September 3). The best options open before it now are either to put the agreement to vote in Parliament or at least initiate a discussion to dispel the misunderstandings. K.V. RAGHURAM, *on e-mail*

Though the magazine has done a good job by presenting all political perspectives, there is a question that still remains unanswered: Why are the Americans seemingly keener on the deal than the Indians? Could the answer to this be linked to the Left's objections? R.N. KOHLI, *Delhi*

The deal is being opposed with an eye on the Muslim votes. Not only this, it is the M-factor that is responsible for preventing tough laws against terrorism and

illegal migration to come into force.

A.K. AJMANI, *on e-mail*

The story on Manmohan Singh is a classic example of journalistic volte face. In the previous issue ("Talking Tough", August 27), he had been transformed into a mature leader while in this issue he has been branded as politically naive who has made a mess out of the nuclear deal. S.K. KUMAR, *Meerut*

The Left has always followed an ideology dictated by foreign leaders. And it is well on its way to commit another blunder if it topples the Government over the nuclear issue. J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

In the din that all major political parties have succeeded in creating, they seem to have forgotten to take into consideration the common man's opinion,

who is the ultimate beneficiary or victim of all the policies formulated by the powers that be. VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

It is ironical to see the Manmohan Government facing disintegration rather than be acclaimed for scripting India's new nuclear power status. Political opportunists with their obsolete ideologies are not only destabilising the Government but are also thwarting the nation's long-term global aspirations. K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

Predictable Predictions

It was difficult to understand the reason for publishing the astrologers' views ("Will the Government Fall?", September 3). However, their opposing views prove that astrology is bunkum and a fraud that charlatans commit on the gullible. S. M. MATHUR, *Lucknow*

With the media adding spice to the issue, the Indo-US nuclear deal seems to be the most hilarious thing to happen to the otherwise pedestrian UPA regime. The astrologers are having a time of their life by making wild guesses even as the issue simply boils down to an ego clash between the prime minister and CPI(M) supremo Prakash Karat. H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

Featuring astrological predictions on an issue as serious as the fall of the Government was quite frivolous. That all of them contradict each other's predictions should have enabled the magazine to save its three pages. It should have instead featured random insights of 10 common people. RAJARSHI CHOWDHURY, *Roorkee*

Bouquets and Brickbats

The magazine has correctly pointed out